Vincent Peiling Li

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Education

University of Cambridge | MPhil in Linguistics and Language Science — October 2026 – June 2027 (Predicted)

University of Edinburgh | B.Sc. Psychology — Edinburgh, United Kingdom

- **Grade**: First Class Honours (74/100, 4.00/4.00 equivalent) — September 2022 – July 2026
- **Relevant Courses**: Dissertation (85/100); Data Analysis for Psychology in R I&II; Human Speech (80/100, 1st of 51); Psychology of Conversation;
- **Audit:** Linguistics IA & IIB; Phonetic Analysis and Empirical Methods; Discourse Analysis; Speech Production and Perception; Natural Language Processing for Psychologists

University of Cambridge | Cambridge Access to Mental Health and Psychology Programme — August – September 2023

Publications and Presentations

Manuscripts & publications

(Under Revision) **Li, V.**, Sturt, P. (2026) *Do Face Emojis Elicit Parafoveal-on-Foveal Effects During Sarcasm Comprehension? Evidence from Eye Tracking in Chinese.*

Conference Poster Presentations

Li, V., Sturt, P. (2026, November) *When does an emoji's fit with the sentence start to matter? Late sentence–emoji congruency in Chinese sarcasm reading.* Poster at *Cambridge Language Science Annual Symposium*, Cambridge, UK.

Li, V., Sturt, P. (2026, September) *Do Face Emojis Elicit Parafoveal-on-Foveal Effects During Sarcasm Comprehension? Evidence from Eye Tracking in Chinese.* Poster at *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*, Saarbrücken, Germany.

Li, V., Corley, M. (2026, September) *Does Capitalisation Facilitate Sarcasm Comprehension? Evidence from Self-paced Reading.* Poster at *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*, Saarbrücken, Germany.

Conference Talk Presentations

Li, V., Corley, M. (2026, May) *Are you being SARCASTIC? Capitalisation Effects on Sarcasm Comprehension in Online Text Communication.* Talk presented at *British Psychological Society Undergraduate Conference*, Glasgow, UK.

Li, V. (2025, November) *Motivation vs Personality: What Drives Belonging for International Students?* Talk presented at *The EAP Student: Identity, Community, and Belonging Conference*, Edinburgh, UK.

Li, V. (2023, May). *Real-life Café vs. Virtual Café Noise Effects on Creative Work Performance*. Talk presented at *Edinburgh Scientific Research Association Annual Conference*, Edinburgh, UK.

Other writing & public engagement

Li, V. (2025, May). Social Media's Double-Edged Sword on Imposter Syndrome: Platforms as Both Triggers and Tools for Resilience. *Edinburgh University Psychology Magazine.*

Awards and Fundings

Pitt Award for EDI and Social Justice (£ 200, see *post*) — July, 2026

Carnegie Trust Vocation Scholarship (£ 5,292) — June – August 2025

Edinburgh Award (*Leadership in Student Opportunities*) — May 2024 & May 2026

Saltire Award (*Psychology Programme Representative*) — May 2024 & May 2026

Student Partnership Agreement Small Project Funding (£ 270) — October 2023 – March 2024

Edinburgh Scientific Research Association Grant (£ 100) — October 2022 – May 2023

Key Research Experience

University of Edinburgh — Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Independent Projects, supervised by Prof. Martin Corley

Project: ***Linguistic inspection time*** — July 2026 – Present

- Investigating whether linguistic processing speed is a specialised faculty or dissociates from general cognitive speed, using a novel linguistic inspection time paradigm programmed in JavaScript.
- Currently at the experiment design and piloting stage.

Project: ***How conversation condition affects language prediction*** — May 2025 – Present

- Investigating whether an explicitly communicative context shifts expectations from typicality-driven to informativity-driven predictions, predicting fewer looks to the stereotypical object.
- Created stimuli, built the experiment using EyeLink 1000 and OpenSesame, currently collecting data.

Undergraduate Dissertation Project (Grade: 85)**,** supervised by Prof. Martin Corley October 2025 – May 2026

Project: ***How capitalisation affects sarcasm comprehension in online communication***

- Independent dissertation on whether capitalisation (e.g., That is GREAT) helps sarcasm comprehension using online self-paced reading.
- Designed and implemented the experiment using PCIbex (JavaScript), collected 113 participants; Results suggest capitalisation functions as a pragmatic salience marker rather than a sarcasm-specific cue; journal manuscript in preparation.
- This project is presented on *BPS Scotland Undergraduate Conference 2026* at the University of Strathclyde Glasgow and will be presented at *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing* (AMLaP) at Saarland University.

Summer Research Project (*Carnegie Trust Vocation Scholarship***,** £ 5,292)**,** supervised by Dr. Patrick Sturt June 2025 – August 2026

Project: ***Parafoveal-on-Foveal Effects of Emojis in Sarcasm Comprehension During Chinese Text Reading***

- Pre-registered study on parafoveal processing and semantic incongruency effects of face emojis on sarcasm comprehension in Chinese text communication.
- Independently designed and programmed the eye-tracking experiment using EyeLink 1000 and Experiment Builder, collected 66 Chinese adults, analysed eye-tracking data, and manuscript in preparation.
- Results suggest that emoji–word semantic congruency influences late re-reading but not initial processing, showing a different pattern from previously reported effects of object emojis.
- This project will be presented at *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing* (AMLaP) at Saarland University, and currently under second round of review for journal publication.

Independent Project, supervised by Prof. Martin Corley

Project: ***How Direct/Indirect narratives affects comprehension of written sarcasm*** October 2024 – October 2025

- Pre-registered study on whether sarcasm is easier to understand direct quotations (he said "this is great") than indirect quotations (“he said that it was great”) using a self-pace reading paradigm.
- Designed and implemented an online experiment using PCIbex (JavaScript), created stimuli and materials, analysed data.
- Initial results suggest readers comprehend sarcasm faster in direct quotations, though the effect is not statistically significant.

Research Assistant to HollyMartin lab July 2024 – October 2024

Project: ***Predicting language under difficult conditions: Effects of cognitive load, noise, and hearing impairment***

- Supported the ESRC-funded project with University of Nottingham investigating prediction in language comprehension under adverse conditions and was supervised by Prof. Martin Pickering and Dr. Naomi Nota.
- Recruited participants at Edinburgh site and conducted in-person eye-tracking experiment; collected, organised and managed participant data for multi-site collaboration.
- Contribution is acknowledged in the preprint at *doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qphfc_v1*.

Research Skills

Programming & Statistics

- **Programming:** R (Proficient), Python, JavaScript.
- **Statistical modelling:** Univariate and Multivariate analyses, linear mixed-effects models, Bayes statistics

Experimental & Analytical Tools

- **Experiment Design**: MATLAB, Psychtoolbox, E-Prime, PCIbex, Qualtrics, Prolific, Testable
- Eye-tracking: EyeLink 1000 (SR Research), Experiment Builder
- **Analysis & Discourse Coding**: RStudio, SPSS, Praat, ELAN, NVivo

Academic and Professional Engagement

Linguistic Programme Student Representative October 2026 – Present

Student Ambassador of BALEAP (The British Association of Lecturers in English for Academic Purposes) November 2024

British Psychological Society Student Ambassador August 2024 – May 2026

Volunteer Organiser of AMLaP 2024 (Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing) September 2024

Undergraduate Psychology Programme Representative (Years 2 – 4) September 2023 – May 2026

Student Advisor & Co-manager of Curriculum Transformation September 2023 – May 2024